Between Substance and Ideological Cheap-Talk: Analyses of Political Language in the Pakistani Parliament

Noman Ahmad (IBA Karachi); Xiaolong Hou (LUMS)

Category	Count
Total official debate PDFs cataloged	4,836
Debates with extractable text layer	4,804
Scanned image-only debates (preserved)	32
Active parliamentary sitting years	66
Absent years (martial law / suspensions)	14
Total extracted member-sitting passages	245,428
Sub-procedural interjections (<40 words)	42,635
Substantive analytical frame (≥40 words)	202,793
English-language passages	174,309
Urdu-language passages	26,762
Mixed-code bilingual passages	1,722
InPage-corrupted passages (vision-recovered)	6,374
Question-answer oversight dyads	11,922
Attendance and leave records	8,665
Individual parliamentarians tracked	1,487
Political parties identified	193
Parliamentary sittings indexed	1,626

Notes: Debates cover 1947–2026. Substantive passages (40 or more words) form the sampling universe; the English, Urdu, and mixed-code rows sum to 202,793.